



△ Armstrong Whitworth Siskin III 1923

Origin UK

Engine 400hp Armstrong Siddeley Jaguar IV supercharged 14-cylinder radial

Top speed 156mph (251km/h)

Lessons learned from WWI produced the aerobatic Siskin biplane fighter for the RAF. In IIIA form it was the RAF's first all-steel framed fighter—and very rapid when fitted with a supercharger.



△ Morane-Saulnier MS138 1927

Origin France

Engine 80hp Le Rhône 9Ac air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 88mph (142km/h)

France had always tended to prefer monoplanes, so its primary training two-seater was this light monoplane with slightly sweptback parasol wings and fabric-covered, wood-framed fuselage.



△ Fairey III F 1926

Origin UK

Engine 570hp Napier Lion XI liquid-cooled Broad Arrow

Top speed 120mph (192km/h)

Versions of Fairey III served in both WWI and WWII on reconnaissance duty: conceived as a carrier-borne seaplane, it was built with three seats for the Fleet Air Arm and two for the RAF.



△ Hawker Tomtit 1928

Origin UK

Engine 150hp Armstrong Siddeley Mongoose IIIc air-cooled 5-cylinder radial

Top speed 124mph (200km/h)

The RAF disliked wood-framed aircraft, so Sydney Camm designed the Tomtit trainer with steel/duralumin frame and an all-fabric covering. It did not win the contract, so only 35 were built.



△ Hawker Hart 1928

Origin UK

Engine 525hp Rolls-Royce Kestrel 1B liquid-cooled V12

Top speed 185mph (298km/h)

Sleek and aerodynamic, the Hart was the most prolific British military aircraft of the interwar years with 992 built. A light bomber, it was faster than contemporary fighters, carrying 529lb (240kg) of bombs.



△ Morane-Saulnier MS230 1929

Origin France

Engine 230hp Salmson 9AB air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 127mph (204km/h)

Much faster than the MS138, this would be the main elementary trainer for the French Armée de l'Air throughout the 1930s; more than 1,000 were built. It was very easy to fly and sold worldwide.